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\$110,000 Teen Grant Cut By City Council

O.C.L.C. VOWS CONTINUED COMMUNITY SERVICE

(Oakland, Calif.) - Responding to the Oakland City Council cut off two weeks ago of a \$110,000 grant for youth services at the Oakland Community Learning Center (OCLC), the EOC Service Corporation — which has administered the popular teen program for over three years — has pledged to continue the vitally needed programs, declaring that "they fill a void that cannot be filled by city agencies or governmental commissions."

In a press statement released on March 30, two days after the City Council's vote, the EOC Service Corporation noted that it was the first of five city agencies funded by the Alameda County Criminal Justice Planning Board (ACCJPB) to provide teen services to begin operations, on June 8, 1977, and, indeed, had been functioning since September, 1974, "with little other than community interest, need and enthusiasm."

All eight City Council members voted to terminate the grant, of which only \$43,585 had been received as of last October when a city audit of the program suspended funding.

Mayor Lionel Wilson abstained from voting on the grounds of conflict of interest. He once served on the administrative board of Educational Opportunities Corporation, the non-profit group which operates the model



Black Oakland youth participating in activities of the EOC Service Corporation-sponsored teen program at the Oakland Community Learning Center (OCLC). Despite a major cutback in funding, the OCLC has vowed to continue to serve the Black and poor community.

elementary level Oakland Community School, which is also located in the OCLC at 6118 East 14th Street.

The teen program was originally initiated at

the OCLC, which was founded in the fall of 1974 by the Black Panther Party, at the request of concerned parents. At that time, the East
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Property Tax Amendment Would Cut Services For Poor

STATEWIDE OPPOSITION MOUNTS AGAINST PROPOSITION 13

(Oakland, Calif.) - A broadbased coalition is growing throughout the state in opposition to Proposition 13, the controversial proposed property tax amendment, which, if passed in the upcoming June election, could cause public schools to close, massive unemployment and a severe cutback in social service programs for poor people.

Proposition 13, also known as the "Jarvis-Gann Amendment" for the bill's co-authors, Howard Jarvis and Paul Gann, would amend the California Constitution to limit property taxes on all real property to one per cent of full cash value, based on 1975-76 values.

Allegedly designed to benefit homeowners, Proposition 13, in fact, provides a windfall in profits to major landlords and causes a loss of seven million dollars in vital local and state revenues.

In an interview last week with THE BLACK PANTHER, Tim Nesbitt, noted Oakland researcher and public information officer for Service Employees' International Union, AFL-CIO, Local 616, explained the disastrous effects that passage of the Jarvis-Gann Amendment could bring.

"Proposition 13 is designed to give a large



Poverty-stricken Black man in downtown Oakland. Under Proposition 13, vital social services for poor people would be cut.

tax break to all property owners, including landlords and businessmen who are primarily the owners of commercial and industrial property," Nesbitt said.

"But these are not the people who are feeling the weight of property taxes. It's the homeowners who have been hardest hit because of increased assessments which have forced them to pay a larger and larger share of property taxes over the years. Right now they pay almost 37 per cent of total property taxes in the state," Nesbitt continued.

A landlord who pays a substantial amount of property tax will have that tax cut drastically. But in the current tight rental market, no rent rollbacks are likely, so profits will increase immediately.

The increased income and lowered tax burden will also mean an immediate rise in the value of the property. But while property values and net income rise immediately, assessment increases in the tax initiative are permitted to increase by only two per cent per year.

Assessments are increased to market value only when the property is sold. So landlords
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